

THE BLACK PANTHER

25
cents

Black Community News Service



VOL. V NO. 20

SATURDAY, NOVEMBER 14, 1970

PUBLISHED
WEEKLY

THE BLACK PANTHER PARTY

MINISTRY OF INFORMATION
BOX 1961, CUSTOM HOUSE
SAN FRANCISCO, CA 94136

ON THE BATTLEFIELD IN CAIRO, ILLINOIS



DEATH TO THE FASCIST PIGS

The following is a statement by the Rev. Charles Rans, executive director of the United Front of Cairo concerning a new conference held by Governor Richard Ogilvie at which the Governor announced he was sending additional state police and an armed car to Cairo in response to the days of violence in this city.

On February 4, 1970, the Governor met with the Mayor and the Council of the city of Cairo in Springfield and following that meeting sent 200 troops into the community to "protect" the Black community for four months.

On August 28, the Governor met with the Mayor and the Council of the city of Cairo and the Council of the National White Citizens Council (NKKKK) and a delegation of White Citizens Council supporters.

On August 29, Senator Ralph T. Smith, the Governor's whipping boy met with Vernon Berbling, organizer of the White Citizens Council (and State's attorney of Alexander County), and four other state attorneys. Sen. Smith promised Berbling law and order money from

precipitated the rest of the existing firing.

What city officials now say a meeting was held on Friday afternoon, Oct. 23, between the mayor and fire chief and police chief. At this meeting they decided the more would be burned and because of the "possibility" of sniper fire, they would not go to fight the fire.

There was a fire at the store. The fire department was called. They did not respond to the call. The truth: No sniper fire was directed at firemen. The first shots came from the police station. Blacks gathered fire toward the store at the end of 11th Street. This return fire came from the vicinity of Pyramid Court.

What city officials first said: The police station was hit by hundreds of rounds of ammunition. Some have said 400 by Blacks from all sides of the police station.

What city officials now say: There was one bullet that went through a second floor window and 13 other shots hit the station.

A "crowd" on the roof of the four story police station, Cairo police have used a machine gun from this point and have shot into the rectory and Pyramid Court from it.

What city officials said and the truth: City officials in an obvious well-planned attempt to destroy the Blacks of Cairo, especially the United Front, carried out these vicious sniper attacks in the Black community. They had invited crystals carefully selected newsmen into the police station to witness the events of violence by Blacks. While newsmen were inside in safe places, the firing started and police provided them with "details" of the events. Following this the mayor began massive attempts to publicize "what happened".

A careful investigation of the

leaves only a Black jailer. These men have resigned because of racist policies in the department and because of a fear that racist

police and deputies might be shot while they are in performance of their duties.

Several White policemen have retired or resigned including Capt. Abell (retired), Officer Simmons, Chairman, Thomas and Williams. Retiring policemen helped them to seek other employment. The law section chief recently stated he always been on the vanguard of the White vigilantes. It can be easily seen that Blacks of Cairo will be subject to more and more police harassment and intimidation and arrests by these "legal" White vigilantes.

INCIDENTS OF VIOLENCE, BY WHITES, AGAINST THE BLACK COMMUNITY SINCE MARCH 21, 1969

at least 3 occasions--store 417 rectory on October 23, 1970.
St. Columba School, United Front Offices--fire bombed, shot into 4 months on Oct. 22, 1970.
Wilson Restaurant--shot into as recently as October 22, 1970.
Black Pentecostal Church--200 Loost, one block north of Pyramid Court) burned to the ground October 16, 1970.
Foodstore--fire-bombed.
Two Other Uptown Stores--fire-bombed.
One Uptown restaurant--fire-bombed.

Lawyer's Committee--shot into as recently as October 23, 1970.
Lawyer (Quander)--blinded, shot into twice as recently as October 23, 1970.

STORIES OF BLACK COMMUNITY (OCTOBER 23, 1970) CHINESE, CHINESE, SEVERAL shot into, firebombed.
Johnny--4th Street, burned to the ground October 23, 1970.
Johnny--4th Street, burned to the ground October 17, 1970.
Chinese Uptown--firebombed.

WHERE BLACKS WORKED
Solomon's Jewelry--burned.
Urban Pacific Warehouse--burned to the ground.



SHOOT TO KILL

Washington which would enable the county to prosecute the heavy case load which consists of many Blacks who have been trained on ridiculous charges. The Governor is a racist and anything he may do or say now will reflect the continuation of racist practices of moves which have been made against the Black community here in Cairo.

The shipping of an armed truck and state troopers to the Cairo community motivated the United Front to prepare for the winter offensive of the White vigilante groups and we ask Black and White citizens to send money and food to the Cairo community for the Black spirit Thanksgiving to help the Blacks to overcome the bitter winter months. Such support would also help us overcome the aggression of the local, state and federal officials against the peaceful innocent and effective struggle here in Cairo.

SOME INTERESTING FACTS CONCERNING VIOLENCE IN CAIRO

What city officials first said: A fire truck attempting to respond to a fire at a grocery store on 11th Street, across from Pyramid Court, was turned back by heavy sniper fire from inside Pyramid Court. There were the shots which

building.
The truth: One bullet hit the police station. There is evidence that a White fired that one shot. Blacks would not fire from four sides--one of which would be in the White community. Rock marks have been in the police station for months at least.

What city officials first said: Black guerrillas wearing camouflage clothes, wearing weapons, got out of cars in front of the police station and 14-24 of these Blacks fired into the station. Blacks were also shooting into the police station from the school on 11th Street and from Pyramid Court.

What city officials now say: There may have been three Blacks who were between two buildings in front of the police station firing at us. There were undoubtedly others in the ground.

The truth: Blacks were not armed and in the vicinity of the police station. It would be physically impossible to either see or hit the police station from either Pyramid Court or the school. It is possible to hit the rectory and the top of the church and the 200 roof of Pyramid Court from

facts shows that the Mayor of Cairo is beyond belief, his credibility surely tried from past falsification, has been completely destroyed now. Black people of Cairo still attempt to live in peace but they will defend themselves.

In recent days a new group of deputies has been appointed by the new sheriff. The sheriff himself has been active with the White vigilantes. An officer he appointed 300 White vigilantes, like line of deputies ready like an honor-roll of the whites. He also has appointed ten additional deputies (names unknown) to be under the command of Mayor Thomas a man totally untrained and unskilled in law-enforcement and who has moved against Blacks for years.

There are no Blacks on the police force. Officer Melick resigned on October 13. Officer Melick resigned October 27. Sergeant Board was suspended for 30 days and will not return to the force. Officer Thomas has retired. This

Black businessmen and establishments victims of violence:
Vivian Living Record Shop--fire-bombed 5 times, looted 6 times.

finally burned to the ground.
Sica Market--fired into 4 times, fire-bombed as recently as October 24, 1970.

Palace Clothing Store--fired into, bricked.
Stella Mae's (Tavern)--fired into, bricked.

Johnny Donahoe's Restaurant (Downtown)--burned to the ground.
J & L Soul Food--bricked and shot into.

Sams Tavern--burned to the ground.
Avery's Tavern--about 100 rounds of ammunition fired into it on October 23, 1970.

Pre-66 Clothing Factory--fire-bombed, partially destroyed.
Watts Garage--fired into.
Recreation Centers--fired into, fire-bombed.

Car Wash--part of an abandoned store on 11th--burned to the ground.
St. Columba Church--fired into as

Grain Company North of Pyramid Court at Levee--burned to the ground.

Grain Company South of Pyramid Court at Levee--burned to the ground.

BLACK HOMES BURNED

Two on 11th Street, occupied, October 17, 1970.

Two on 12th Street, occupied, October 17, 1970.

Uptown--Popular Street Area--46 Black homes burned to ground but all occupied.

Uptown in White Community--Supply Yard--fire-bombed, bricked, shot into several times, fire-bombed as recently as October 23, 1970. Another Black family living next to it. White patrolmen shot into it to force case integration. Public schools, and their own--fire-bombed on Thursday, October 22, and were forced to leave the state.

At least 25 cars owned by Blacks in Cairo and the area have been burned. Shot into, white vigilantes on fire, etc.

On 14th Street, as of October 27, 1970, Pyramid Court another section of the Black community has been fired into. This is in addition to 43 Black homes, in various parts of the city, including the 14th Street for the United Front which have been shot into by White terrorists.